fact that the NSA was aware al-Qaeda had changed its communications procedures meant the NSA was still able to track the group.

Of great concern to the US Intelligence Community was whether Russia or China had been able to access Snowden's cache of documents on his computers. US government officials acknowledged they had no evidence of this, and Snowden insisted he did not expose any files while he was in China and brought none of the documents with him to Russia.

Amnesty or Face Charges?

If Snowden's case were presented to a grand jury for an indictment—a formal charge of a serious crime—the three charges against him could easily increase, so that instead of 30 years he might face a sentence of life in prison. In December 2013, NSA Deputy Director Richard Ledgett considered giving Snowden amnesty if he returned the remainder of the documents that had not yet been published. Ledgett's boss, NSA Director Keith Alexander, did not agree with Ledgett. Not only did Alexander think Snowden should be held accountable for his actions, he did not want to set an example to other people who might do the same thing

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